

Title: Call with Erin Chalk, U.S. Attorney's Office (Jackson, MS)

Date & Time: July 15, 2025 | 4:57 PM CST

Participants:

- Matthew Reardon (MR) – Journalist and complainant
 - Erin Chalk (EC) – Assistant U.S. Attorney, Southern District of Mississippi
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MR:

Outside of the Governor's Mansion, I was peacefully protesting on the sidewalk. I'm a journalist—I believe wholeheartedly in the First Amendment. It must be preserved at all costs. I was exercising my rights, and a state trooper that was there at the shack got completely triggered and told me to take my sign and go across the street.

I told him I was on the public sidewalk and I was perfectly fine. And he charged at me—threatening me. He came within about an arm's length of me, pushing me out into the road, which was already excessive. But it went from bad to worse.

I demanded a supervisor because I wanted to make an on-site complaint. A supervisor—his last name was White—came over. I was explaining everything that had happened. The supervisor wasn't really concerned about his trooper's actions and instead tried to twist it around on me. But everything was video recorded.

The trooper had now put on his hat and gun belt, came back to the gate, and yelled something. I can't remember what. I said, "You need to get away from me." And then he charged at me—in front of his supervisor and two other troopers—and actually assaulted me. Swung at me, hit me. I blocked it with my arm.

I had a gimbal with a camera. He knocked the camera off the gimbal and stepped on it. The supervisor ran up and told him to deescalate. The other troopers were telling him the same.

I started demanding that charges be filed. A trooper can't just assault somebody. They're supposed to have a higher standard. What's the word I'm looking for... decorum... restraint. I'm blanking. But they're supposed to be trained for that.

It all happened on camera. I've been assaulted before, and cops always say, "Well, we didn't see it." But that wasn't the case here. This happened in the presence of a supervisor and two other uniformed officers.

Just me saying I wanted charges filed on him triggered him again. He busted through all of them—like a linebacker—trying to get to me a third time. Just for saying I wanted charges filed.

I kept demanding his name and badge number. They refused. I think that's obstruction of justice—because I was trying to report a crime and they were concealing his identity. That's not just misconduct. That's criminal obstruction.

I could go the state route, but I believe this clearly falls under federal jurisdiction—18 U.S.C. §242 and likely even §241. I don't think the state is going to take it seriously, and I think that's obvious based on the Governor's silence.

This happened outside his mansion. It's been public. The video has gone viral. Even the secretary at the Mississippi Highway Patrol told me she saw it and couldn't believe what she saw—said he was 100% wrong.

I've called for the Governor to denounce it. Because it sends a message—not just to people in Mississippi, but nationwide. The world's seen it. This looks like Mississippi condones this kind of thing.

Peaceful protesters—journalists—being assaulted? That's where we're at?

EC:

Okay. We do not investigate. We prosecute cases that are brought to us. So I forwarded the voicemail you left with our office to the FBI. I'll follow up and make sure they've received it. Then it's on them to investigate.

I just wanted to share that with you. My office doesn't investigate, so I'm not in a position to comment one way or another.

MR:

I understand they're the ones who investigate, but I've had multiple issues with the FBI in multiple jurisdictions—not just in Mississippi, but also out in Salt Lake City. I don't know why. I feel like the evidence has been crystal clear, but as soon as they hear my name, they shut it down.

I've never committed a federal crime. I've asked for a fair investigation into what the State of Mississippi has done to me for the past eight years. And here's what I believe happened—

I've got a book coming out—American Injustice. It details eight years of public corruption that I've personally experienced and can back with evidence. It started with a few state actors back in 2017. Then every time something was exposed, more people got involved trying to cover it up. And each cover-up required more people.

Eventually, it spilled over into the federal side. A few feds backed up the state people. Then more. And now we've got what I call “trickle-down corruption.”

I've filed three DOJ-OIG complaints. Let me give you one example—

I was sentenced to a year in prison for going to the FBI office in Oxford, Mississippi, to report law enforcement corruption. That should never happen.

Lafayette County had banished me from the county as part of a coerced plea deal. I had a family crisis and pled out to something I didn't do just so I could get out and be with my family. The plea included a banishment clause.

Later, I called the FBI and told them I had evidence of corruption involving Holly Springs PD and the Lafayette County Sheriff's Department. The FBI said they didn't do appointments—just walk-ins.

I explained I was banished but wanted to come anyway. We agreed on a time. I even called the sheriff's department and told them I was going. I recorded that call with Deputy Candace Beavers.

Nobody at the FBI met me. I waited in the lobby for two hours. Days later, I was arrested by Lafayette County and sentenced to a year in prison for violating the banishment clause—just for going to the FBI. I have court transcripts and recordings. That video got traction online.

Nine days after my release, I went to Galveston, Texas, to report on tips about false arrests and racial profiling. As I entered the city, I was pulled over and arrested for DWI—a false charge. I hadn't drunk alcohol in years. I told the officer that. He refused a breath test and took me to the hospital, where I was tortured—held down by six officers and stuck with a needle.

While I was being booked, I heard Deputy Beavers on the phone with the Galveston officer. I sat in jail for 11 months. Two weeks before trial, they extradited me back to Mississippi.

I was never tried in Galveston. They revoked my probation and sentenced me to two years—again, based on lies.

That sentence was vacated this January. I was released January 22nd. The Galveston charge was dismissed. Turns out, I was innocent the whole time. And we even have the calls showing Lafayette County coordinated with Galveston PD.

This was all a conspiracy to silence me.

They auctioned my car. They stripped me of everything. I've been begging the feds to intervene. I even showed proof the FBI lied about our conversations—recorded calls. Yet they've stayed silent. And silence is complicity.

EC:

I understand, but again—I cannot comment on what the FBI did or didn't do. We don't have oversight of them. They investigate, we prosecute.

MR:

But here's the problem—I don't trust them. And I'm asking for y'all to allow me to send this proof directly to your office. I don't want this buried. I know that prosecution decisions don't solely have to come from the FBI. It just needs to come from any federal authority.

So... can I send you the videos?

EC:

Whenever you send anything to my office, I'm going to forward it to the FBI. But yes—you can send it.

MR:

Okay. What's your email?

EC:

Erin.Chalk@usdoj.gov. That's E-R-I-N dot C-H-A-L-K at U-S-D-O-J dot gov.

MR:

Got it. My website is WTPNews.org. The homepage has all of this—videos, documents, everything we just discussed.

I just hope something is done this time. Enough is enough.

EC:

All I can do is receive it and forward it. The FBI will take a look at it. I can't promise anything, one way or another.

MR:

But if I did the same thing to them—assaulted them on camera—I'd be prosecuted. So why is it okay for them to do it to me?

I've already sent this to the Attorney General's office. They know. But they're implicated. Same with the feds, I think. They don't want to admit prior wrongdoing.

EC:

Understood.

MR:

Look, I'm not trying to go after y'all. I just want this to stop. That's all I want. This can't go on any longer.

EC:

Sounds good.

MR:

Thank you, ma'am.